

actly what happened with Amazon when one of its sellers used big data analytics in its products.

Case Study: Amazon/Solid Gold Bomb

In 2012, T-shirts with quotes like "Keep Calm and Rape A Lot" and "Keep Calm and Punch Her" were sold by e-tailer Amazon on its website.

Result. The brand had to suffer the wrath of its customers for selling such offensive products on its site. The supplier too apologised for the error and blamed it on the analytics.

What they didn't know. Using wrong codes and not paying attention to their results can be hazardous for the brand. **EFY**

—Purba Das, senior business journalist, EFY

Navigate Your Way To Success With Google Maps

➤ **Google Maps helps to reduce logistics costs by cutting down on inefficient driving through longer routes.**

On a busy office day, while rushing to work, most of us use Google Maps to know the estimated time of arrival (ETA) and the fastest route available. But a Google Map offers much more than just helping you with your travel time. In fact, reports suggest that Google Maps have improved busi-

ness efficiency by 37 per cent while the productivity of customers has gone up by 40 per cent. Check out the various ways Google Maps has been helping businesses across the globe.

For routing and logistics solutions

Logistics and delivery enterprises need to keep a constant tab on their fleets of vehicles to ensure that correct products are delivered to customers within expected time. In addition to timely delivery, they need to reduce logistics costs by cutting down on inefficient driving through longer routes.

Australia-based Fleetminder is one such tracking solution company, which integrated Geo coding and Street View applications programming interfaces (APIs) to its system for strict fleet monitoring with location, fleet and vehicle attributes. The system provides insight into the most optimised route and accurate location of the destination. It also provides driving style attributes, giving analytics for driver safety. The application has helped to reduce inefficient driving by 50 per cent and cut down fuel costs and employee overtime by 25 per cent while ensuring timely delivery with an overall 20 per cent reduction in incorrect deliveries.

Another example is USA-based Vagabond Mobile Vending Operations, which utilised Google Maps to create a web-based application to get information on each vending machine on a map interface. All the collected data like targeted geographic location, stock level and cash collected by the machine



Google Maps is making life easier for enterprises

made it easier for the operators to build efficient routing solutions and restocking schedules. The solution achieved 15 per cent more revenue through improved stocking, 15 per cent expense reduction through route scheduling and 20 per cent operator margin (as against industry average of 2.5 per cent).

Expand customer reach

Google Map's capabilities of locating a specific store or building can be used to further enhance the customer reach. For instance, Doctor On Demand app uses Google Map APIs to help users locate nearby physicians and healthcare centres accurately based on the location entered. It also allows users to set up a video call with the healthcare specialist. More than 65,000 healthcare centres are listed in the application.